Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Butcher with 9 years of experience in high-street and market meat counters, supported by completed vocational butcher training and HACCP basic food hygiene certification. Experienced in breaking down beef, pork and lamb, boning and trimming, portioning orders, making fresh sausages, advising customers on cuts and cooking, and maintaining temperature records and following hygiene and cleaning procedures. Familiar with FIFO stock rotation and training apprentices.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb *2019–Present*

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Make four kinds of fresh sausage to the shop's recipes: čevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez; produce about 40 kg weekly in the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the čevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb following customer feedback. The čevapi won second place at the 2023 Zagreb County craft meat fair.
- Maintain cold-room and display-counter temperature records, checking twice daily; rotate cold-room stock every morning using FIFO, with older stock at the front.
- Serve about 120 customers on a Saturday, advising on cuts and cooking times.
- Train two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting orders, including ordering, butchering, seasoning and delivery. This has included catering for weddings and family parties; the largest order was four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding in 2024.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial on beef ribs, keeping weight-loss and temperature records. Dry-aged rib is now sold by pre-order, at about 15 kg per month.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb *2015–2019*

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Wrote a one-page closing and cleaning checklist after a hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015

HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024

Preparing for the master butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027; not yet passed.

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) • Boning and trimming • Portioning meat to order • Fresh sausage making • Knife sharpening • Mincer and bandsaw operation • FIFO stock rotation • Cold-chain temperature checks and hygiene procedures • Customer service and product advice • Cash handling • Cleaning and sanitising equipment • Hand pallet jack

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) • English (good; customer service) • German (basic)